



HAMPDEN-SYDNEY COLLEGE

Math 121: Statistics (3 credits) Fall 2026

Instructor	Brian Lins
Email Address	blins@hsc.edu
Course Meeting Times	MWF 11:30am - 12:20pm (Section 02) & MWF 1:30pm - 2:20pm (Section 04)
Course Meeting Location	Pauley 100 (Section 02) & Pauley 105 (Section 04)
Office Hours	MW 2:30 - 4:00pm & R 12:30 - 2:00pm See the course website: https://bclins.github.io
Textbook	OpenIntro Statistics, 4th edition by Diez, Cetinkaya-Rundel, & Barr

Course Description

Introduction to probability and statistics. Exploratory data analysis. Discrete and continuous random variables, estimation, hypothesis testing.

Course Learning Objectives

- Students will be able to read and interpret graphs of quantitative data.
- Students will be able to perform calculations related to the normal distribution.
- Students will be able to set up, calculate, and interpret both confidence intervals and hypothesis tests.

Required Materials

None. See the course website for links to the free textbook.

Attendance Policy

Attendance in this class is required. Repeated absences may result in a forced withdrawal from the course. You are responsible for any material you miss due to absence. Please let me know ahead of time if you know that you will not be able to attend class.

Grading Policy

The term grade will be based on the following factors.

Component	Proportion
Midterms	45%
Projects	6%
Quizzes	24%
Final Exam	25%

In-Class Problems

There is a saying that, “you learn math by doing math.” This is very true! During most class periods you will be asked to solve problems in-class. Any problems you do not complete during class become homework problems. I do not collect these problems however. Instead, you may consult your notes and completed classwork during the weekly quizzes.

Quizzes

Every Friday (except when there is a midterm exam) there will be a 10-15 minute quiz on recently covered material. Each quiz will have 3 or 4 problems and will cover material similar to the in-class and take-home problems. During quizzes you are allowed to use your (paper) notes and solutions to old class workshop problems. You can also use a calculator. Laptops, tablets, and other electronic devices are not allowed during quizzes. There are no make-up quizzes for absences. If you know that you will miss class on a Friday for an excused absence (athletic or other school sponsored event), then let me know in at least one day in advance so that we can arrange an alternative assignment. The lowest quiz grade will be dropped from the final average.

Projects

There will be four homework projects at the end of the semester. These projects will require you to analyze real world data, make graphs, carry out relevant statistical tests, and explain your conclusions. The projects must be typed using a computer and you can e-mail them to me when they are due. If you wish, you may work with a partner on the project. If you do work with a partner then you can both submit one file together, just be sure that both of your names are clearly listed on the file that you submit. Aside from work with your partner, all work should be your own. Each project will be graded holistically using the following rubric:

1. **Grade: A.** Every part of the assignment is complete and your work is clear and correct.
2. **Grade: B.** Almost every part of the assignment is complete and your work is clear. There may be a few minor mistakes, but no major errors.
3. **Grade: C.** Most of the assignment is complete, but is either not clear or has significant mistakes.
4. **Grade: D.** You turn in something, but it has major errors or omissions.

The dates listed for the projects on the schedule below are when the projects *will be assigned*, not when they are due. You will have at least 3 days from when a project is assigned until it will be due.

Exams

There will be three in-class midterm exams and a cumulative final. These exams will be announced in advance, and you will know exactly what concepts will be covered on each exam. Unlike the quizzes, you will not be able to consult your notes during exams.

Course Schedule

The schedule below is tentative, and may be subject to change. Changes will be announced in class, and you are responsible for knowing about any changes even if you miss the class when they are announced.

Week	Topic	Projects
1	Data tables & summaries	Project 1 Project 2 Project 3 Project 4
2	Standard deviation & normal distribution	
3	Normal distribution probabilities	
4	Linear regression	
5	Sampling, Midterm 1	
6	Randomized experiments & probability	
7	Law of large numbers	
8	Sampling distributions	
9	Confidence intervals, Midterm 2	
10	Hypothesis testing	
11	Comparing two proportions	
12	Inference about means	
13	Two sample t-methods, Midterm 3	
14	Statistical power	
15	Chi-squared test for association	

Late Work and Make-Up Assignment Policy

Please let me know at least one day in advance if you will be missing class on a quiz day. If you let me know ahead of time that you will be missing a quiz for a religious holiday or school sponsored event, then we can plan an alternative assignment or waive the quiz from your average. If you don't let me know until after the fact, then it will be too late. There are no make-up quizzes. That's why I drop your lowest quiz grade.

Grading Scale

This course adheres to the grades and quality points described in the Academic Catalogue. Consult the Academic Catalogue for a detailed description.

Honor Code

Students are expected to abide by the Honor Code for all assignments unless a professor indicates otherwise. Students should consult the Academic Catalogue and The Key: The Hampden-Sydney College Student Handbook for the College's description of the Honor Code and what it identifies as infractions of the Honor Code.

Artificial Intelligence Policy

You are welcome and even encouraged to use artificial intelligence to help study before quizzes and tests. But all outside resources (including AI) are prohibited during quizzes and tests. You should not use AI to help with any part of the homework projects. Including AI generated text or results in your projects is plagiarism.

Accommodations

Hampden-Sydney College is committed to ensuring equitable access to its education programs for all students. Under the administration of the Department of Culture and Community, the Office of Accessibility Services (OAS) coordinates reasonable accommodations for qualified students with disabilities. If you wish to seek accommodations for this class, please contact Dr. Melissa Wood, Director of Title IX, Access, and Student Advocacy, at 434-223-6061 or at mwood@hsc.edu. Additional information may be found here: <https://www.hsc.edu/academics/academic-services/disability-services>. Appropriate documentation of disability will be required. For students who have an accommodations letter from OAS, it is essential that you correspond with your professor as soon as possible to discuss your accommodation needs for the course so that appropriate arrangements may be made.